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Culture Summary

Author(S): Rasmussen, Susan J.

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Section Title(S)

KIN GROUPS AND DESCENT • KINSHIP • KINSHIP TERMINOLOGY • LAND TENURE

LAND TENURE

In the pre-colonial times, clan members jointly owned designated grazing grounds by virtue of common descent from a founding ancestor who acquired the land through military conquest. Outsiders were excluded from grazing, hunting and collecting without the permission of clan leaders. Land access and use within each clan was greatly related to social status at birth and parental occupation. Clan chiefs and the nobility maintained their prestigious status by living on nomadic pastoralism, while demanding rent and other services from settled client farmers and artisans.

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KINSHIP

KIN GROUPS AND DESCENT

The introduction of Islam in the seventh century A.D. had the long-term effect of superimposing patrilineal institutions upon traditional matriliney. Formerly, each matrilineal clan was linked to a part of an animal, over which that clan had rights (Casajus 1987; Lhote 1953; Nicolaisen 1963; Norris 1975, 30). Matrilineal clans were traditionally important as corporate groups, and they still exert varying degrees of influence among the different Tuareg confederations. Most Tuareg are bilateral in descent and inheritance systems (Murphy 1964; 1967). Descent-group allegiance is through the mother, social-

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stratum affiliation is through the father, and political office, in most groups, passes from father to son.

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KINSHIP TERMINOLOGY

Tuareg personal names are used most frequently in addressing all descendants and kin of one's own generation, although cousins frequently address one another by their respective classificatory kinship terms. Kin of the second ascending generation may be addressed using the classificatory terms *anna* (mother) and *abba* (father), as may brothers and sisters of parents, although this is variable. Most ascendants, particularly those who are considerably older and on the paternal side, are usually addressed with the respectful term *amghar* (masc.) or *tamghart* (fem.). The most frequently heard kinship term is *abobaz*, denoting "cousin," used in a classificatory sense. Tuareg enjoy more relaxed, familiar relationships with the maternal side, which is known as *tedis*, or "stomach" and associated with emotional and affective support, and more reserved, distant relations with the paternal side, which is known as *aruru*, or "back" and associated with material support and authority over Ego. There are joking relationships with cousins; relationships with affines are characterized by extreme reserve. Youths should not pronounce the names of deceased ancestors.

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Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: ✉ hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: ✉ hraf-support@yale.edu



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